

er 360° banking strategy, which requires employees to have multi-product knowledge and skills. “We don’t select people based on their functional skills; cultural fit is the most important. The bank hires for attitude and trains for skill,” says Srirang.

At the other end, it has also ensured that many of the bank’s HR managers have backgrounds in business roles. Even when it recruits qualified HR professionals, for instance, from top management colleges, they are required to spend the first six months in a

employees are adequately trained,” says Srirang.

It has also established councils with business managers. These councils, led by business leaders and HR teams, meet regularly—at least every quarter—to gather feedback on the impact of training.

BRANCHING OUT

One other aspect that has been reshaped is the branch model. Branches are typically divided into retail, transaction banking, and rural branches. Traditionally,

of a scaleable, future-ready, and data-driven organisation. Employees from across groups undergo skilling in domains like cloud computing and artificial intelligence (AI).

The bank’s digital academy has 15 focus areas. Employees in key areas such as technology, product design, risk management, and audit undergo internal assessments to determine their proficiency—categorised as L1, L2, or L3, corresponding to the requirements of their roles. After that, a road map for skill improvement is provided to employees, and this is also shared with board committees to outline the skill requirements of the bank.

The bank is among the first in its domain to adopt this practice—common in many IT companies. The bank also collaborates with a network of reputed partners, including the Institute for Development and Research in Banking Technology, the International Institute of Information Technology Bangalore, the online learning platform Manipal UNext, and NIIT University.

It operates a leadership academy, focussing on the 800-member leadership team. It has identified five key focus areas within the organisation: data science, technology, design thinking, project management, and adaptive leadership. Each individual is required to undergo one skilling session every six months. Over the next one to two years, the bank aims to enrol all of the leadership team in these programmes, ensuring that each member possesses at least basic knowledge and awareness in these skill areas.

It’s pretty evident that at ICICI Bank, the focus is on improving with the employees. **BT**

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Key HR initiatives

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► **Hire for attitude:** It believes in screening candidates for the right attitude rather than the skill through strong industry-academia partnerships and selective market hiring

► **New-age skills:** The bank is focussing on keeping

its staff up to date with training in data science and technology as part of its Bank to Bank-Tech journey

► **Train for skill:** It has designed developmental programmes on identified future competencies

► **Thought leadership:** It also engages with thought leaders from diverse fields

► **Employee care and enabling work environment:** An inclusive and caring workplace, driven by meritocracy and equal opportunities for all

business role before transitioning to HR. That has meant that all functional training programmes are conducted by internal trainers. When line managers lead training sessions, they impart knowledge based on their current experiences, making the sessions highly practical. This is crucial because the bank is evolving constantly. “With the evolving needs of our customers, our products, services, and delivery systems need to constantly evolve. Our line managers are best suited as trainers to ensure that all the em-

employees in most bank branches focussed primarily on serving consumers in the liabilities business, mainly current account and savings account or CASA deposits. The bank has now transformed branches into business centres, which act as focal points for all products and services offered by it. The branch manager now understands both the risk and the profit and loss.

As part of its ‘Bank to Bank-Tech’ journey, the bank continues to skill employees through its digital academy in line with the vision